

correct permissions.

```
DIR_MODE=0750
```

After correcting the directory permissions using any of the previously mentioned techniques, verify the results using the following syntax:

```
ls -ld /home/username
```

The results below show that world readable permissions have been removed:

```
drwxr-x--- 2 username username 4096 2010-06-12
20:04 username
```

Password policy

A strong password policy is one of the most important aspects of your security posture. Many successful security breaches involve simple brute force and dictionary attacks against weak passwords. If you intend to offer any form of remote access involving your local password system, make sure you adequately address minimum password complexity requirements, maximum password lifetimes, and frequent audits of your authentication systems.

Minimum password length

By default, Ubuntu requires a minimum password length of 4 characters, as well as some basic entropy checks. These values are controlled in the file /etc/pam.d/common-password, which is outlined below.

```
password required pam_unix.so nullok obscure min=4
max=8 md5
```

If you would like to adjust the minimum length to 6 characters, change the appropriate variable to `min=6`. The modification is outlined below.

```
password required pam_unix.so nullok obscure min=6
max=8 md5
```

Password expiration

When creating user accounts, you should make it a policy to have a minimum and maximum password age forcing users to change their passwords when they expire.

To easily view the current status of a user account, use the following syntax:

```
sudo chage -l username
```

The output below shows interesting facts about the user account, namely that there are no policies applied:

```
Last password change          :
Jan 20, 2010
Password expires              :
never
```